

Finance in the age of AI

Transformation for the CFOs office
during and post e-invoicing world



Archit Gupta

Founder & CEO, Cleartax

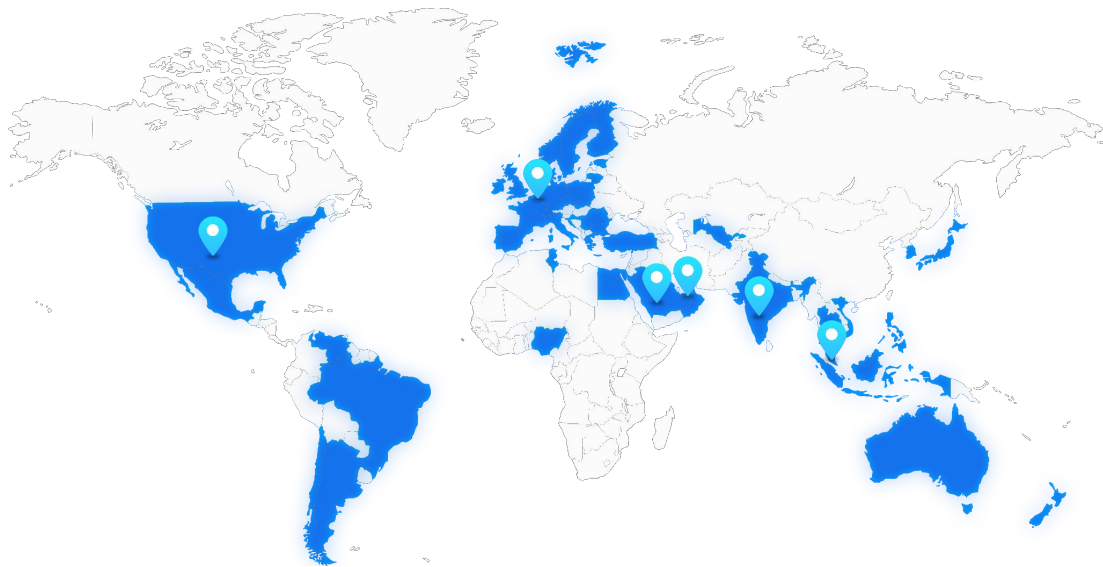
Today we will talk about

e-invoicing

**AI for the
CFO's office**

cleartax

The global tax technology trusted
by finance teams worldwide



Serving Governments &
Businesses since 2011

750+ engineers &
compliance experts

Local UAE entity with local
support

40+

Countries covered globally

5000+

Global enterprises

500M+

e-Invoices generated
annually

\$500B+

worth invoices processed

Cleartax solves everything in & around e-invoicing

VAT compliance

- **Deep reconciliations** on multiple fronts (e.g. Forex, time of supply, date) for sources such as GL, SR, PR)
- **Offered in-built with e-Invoicing** and also as Cleartax compliance cloud

Global e-invoicing

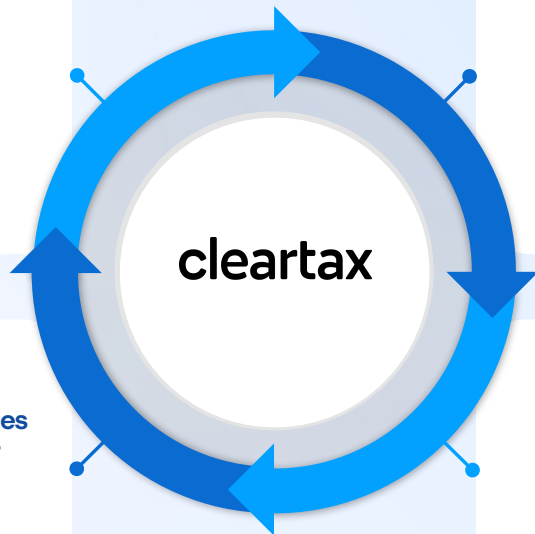
- Use-cases such as **Master data management, Self-billing, DIY error-correction work-flows** designed to simplify e-invoicing for users
- **Partner network** for due diligence and gap analysis to ensure solution configured to taxpayer needs

AP transformation for inward e-Invoices

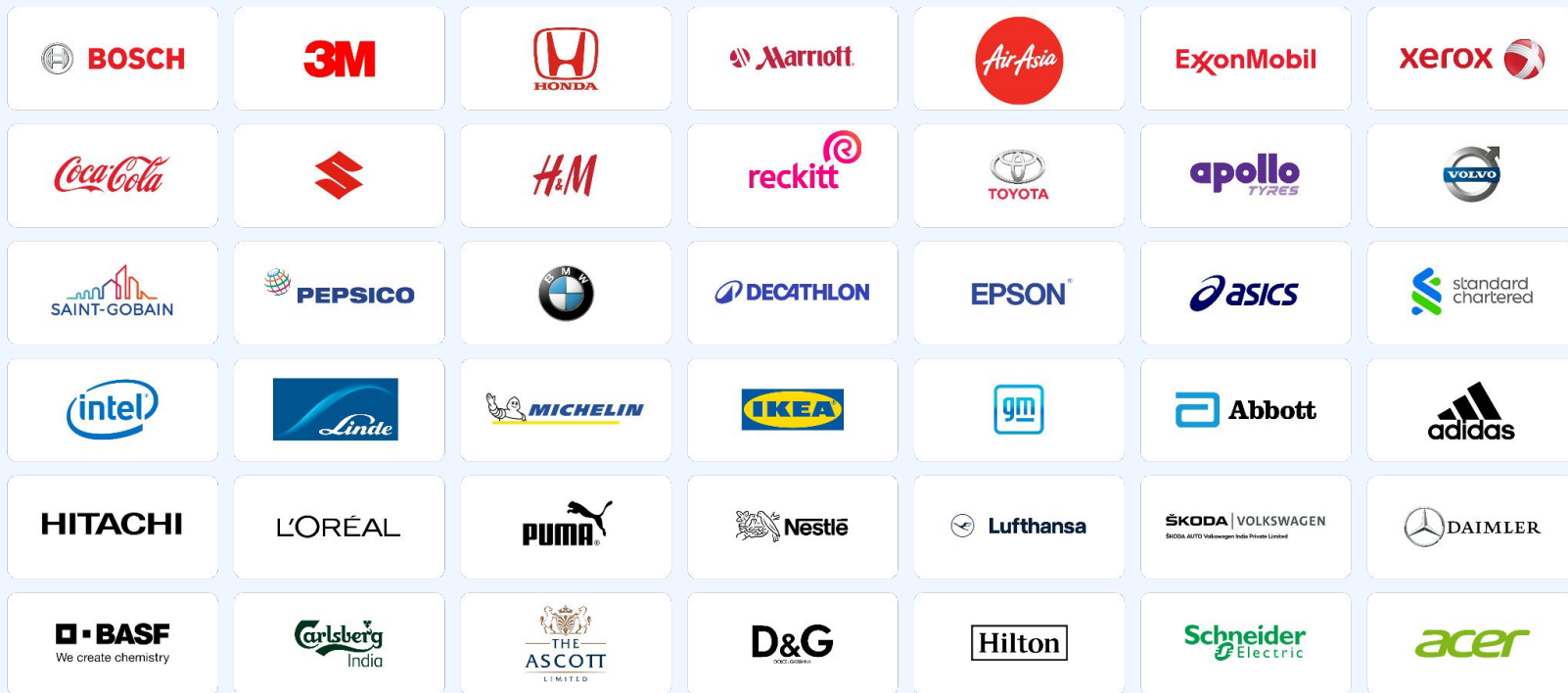
- **AP-inbox, 3 way-reconciliations on purchase e-Invoices** and adjacent offerings as part of Cleartax supply chain cloud

AI agents for CFOs

- Deep innovation ongoing in **fraud detection, many-to-many reconciliations and taxpayers support** using advanced technologies



Powering Fortune 500s worldwide, and growing by 2 new logos everyday





Pioneering ZATCA compliant e-invoicing in GCC

3,000+

Large enterprise
customers for
e-invoicing

\$500B+

Worth
e-invoices
generated

5000+

Individual users
on Cleartax
e-inv solution

500+ Enterprise customers in GCC

400+ Customers live for e-invoicing

PEPPOL ready solution with easy
integration with ERPs

Locally hosted
cloud servers

Powering the world's e-invoicing rails alongside regulators



*Licensed to generate
e-invoice for taxpayers on
behalf of India tax authority*



هيئة الزكاة والضريبة والجمارك
Zakat, Tax and Customs Authority

*Advisory role during Phase-1
e-invoicing pilot; one of the
first service providers to be
approved for Phase-II*



*Aligned with LHDN's
guidelines and is MDEC
accredited*



المهنة الاتحادية للضرائب
FEDERAL TAX AUTHORITY

*Aligned with FTA and in
the process of Service
Provider Accreditation*

Trusted by 500+ large enterprises across GCC

 المهيديب Al Muhaidib	 LANDMARK ARABIA	 Carrefour	 where the world comes to shop, online!	 سلاّم salam	 IKEA	 FITNESSTIME وقت اللياقة	 cenomi
 Sharaf DG	 مجموعة سعيد رداد SAEED RADDAD GROUP	 L'AZURDE	 البواردي ALBAWARDI	 REDTAG	 Isam K. Kabbani Group of Companies	 Arla	 النافع للأغذية ALNAFEA FOODS
 الفلك ALFALAK	 ثامر مخاخ THAMER MAKHAH	 مجموعة البواردي ALBAWARDI GROUP	 قطار الحرمين السريع HAHARAIN HIGH SPEED RAILWAY	 شركة عطاء التعليمية ATAA EDUCATIONAL COMPANY	 Zamil Industrial الزامل للصناعة	 MALABAR GOLD & DIAMONDS CELEBRATING THE BEAUTY OF LIFE	 داكن Daaken
 NIKAI	 Tech Mahindra	 Linde	 اليمامة ALYAMAMA	 TAHWEEL HOLDING	 FOSROC	 باركو الدولية BARCO INTERNATIONAL	 DAILY FOOD شركة الغذاء اليومي
 يونيكتو YUNITCO	 دانة العقارية DANAH REAL ESTATE	 unicharm ユニチャーム	 OPTERN A BELDEN GRU	 ICF	 يونيكيويل UNICOIL	 AL FARIS	 شديد ري CHEDID RE
 AJMAL	 Brands For Less	 AL BLAGHA GROUP مجموعة البلاغية	 جوبال السحيمي GLOBAL SUHAIMI	 جامعة الأمير سلطان PRINCE SULTAN UNIVERSITY	 الجزيرة aljazeera	 SAUDI ESPORTS FEDERATION	

Trusted by multiple Sovereign-sponsored taxpayers in the Gulf

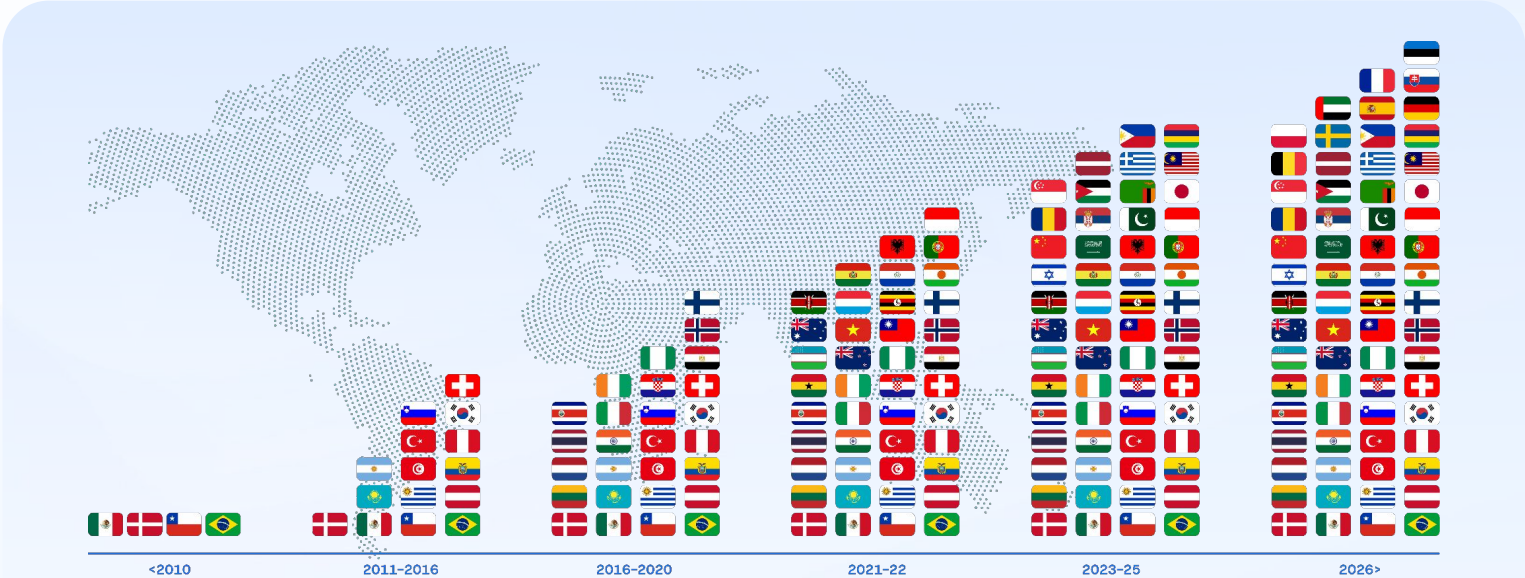


**From the Middle East to the EU,
tax mandates are moving to real-time,
where every e-invoice triggers
compliance automatically.**

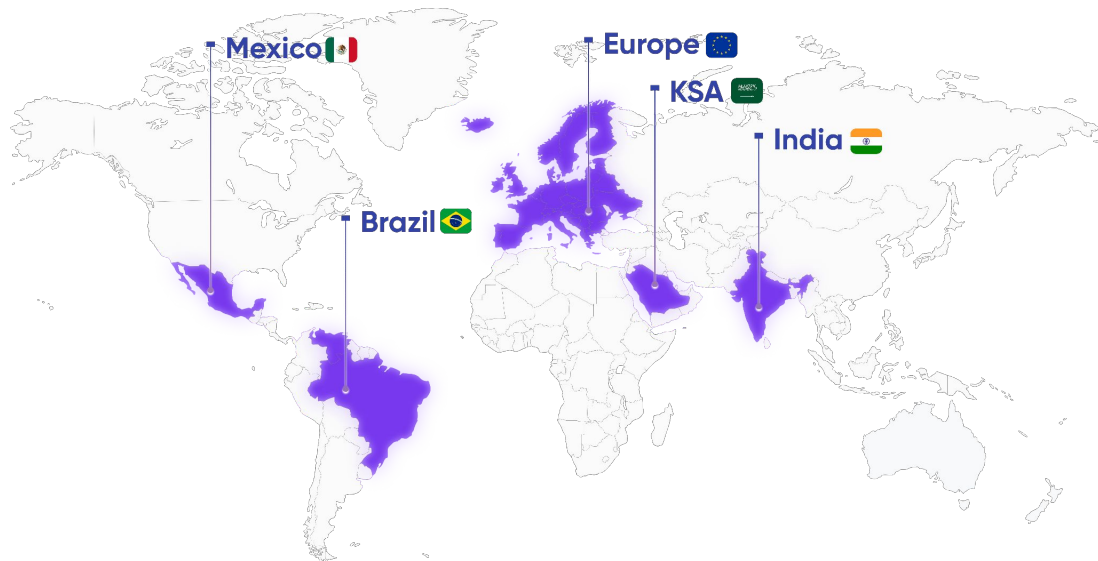
And that future is taking shape across the world...

Over 90 countries have adopted or announced e-invoicing mandates.

By 2030, 75% of global B2B transactions will be electronic.



What the world has taught us about e-invoicing



MENA is at the same turning point that India, Brazil, and Europe once faced.
The decisions CFOs make today will define tomorrow's finance

KSA – b2c e-Invoicing

Leading the way in real-time B2C e-invoicing, transforming compliance for retail and e-commerce at point of sale.

India – scale

12B+ invoices processed annually covering \$2.4 trillion economy; 1 in 10 invoices flows via Cleartax

Brazil – recovery

Recovered over \$58B in tax revenues since e-invoicing rollout

Mexico – financing

90% of SMEs use CFDI data to access credit lines and supply chain financing

Europe – interoperability

EU estimates €134B VAT gap e-invoicing expected to close a significant portion by 2030

E-invoicing in Middle East

Country	Key Milestones (indicative timelines*)
Saudi Arabia (KSA)	• Dec 2020: Regulations introduced. • Dec 2021: Phase 1 (Generation) required — e-invoices & e-notes generation & record-keeping. • 1 Jan 2023: Phase 2 begins — Integration / transmission to ZATCA system. • 2023–2025: Phase 2 rolled out in waves (various revenue thresholds). Recent waves: – Wave 18 (turnover > SAR2m) compliance by 1 June 2025. – Wave 21 (turnover > SAR1.25m) compliance by 30 November 2025.
UAE	• Oct / Nov 2024: Laws & portal launched; regulatory changes introduced (Decree-Laws amendments). • 2025: Preparation (accreditation of service providers, technical specifications) to occur. • July 2026: Phase 1 go-live anticipated (mandatory e-invoicing begins for initial taxpayer groups). • Beyond 2026: More phased inclusion, possibly expanded scope (smaller taxpayers / B2C, etc.).
Oman	• Aug 2025: Tax Authority working with first ~100 large taxpayers for test phase. • Sep 2026: First mandatory wave for large taxpayers, B2B model based on Peppol. • 2027–2028: Subsequent waves expanding to more B2B taxpayers, B2G, etc.
Other	• Bahrain: Planning stage — likely following Oman/UAE. (No confirmed dates yet.) • Qatar: Consultation in progress; timeline likely aligned with VAT implementation phases.

UAE is gearing up on e-invoicing rollout!

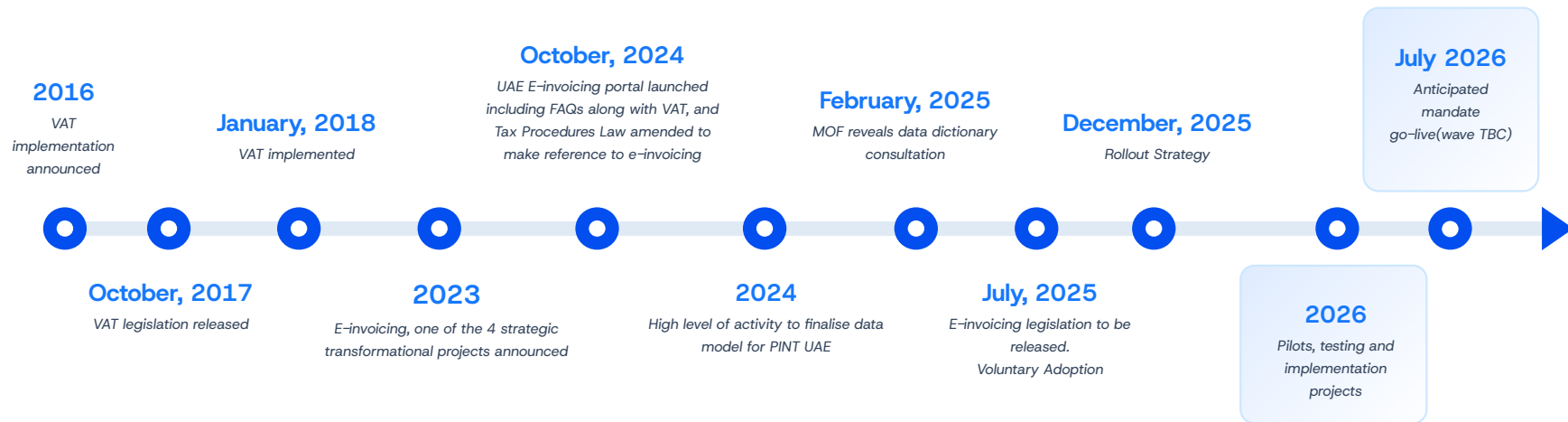
**E-invoicing for B2B & B2G transactions
will be mandatory in the UAE starting July 2026.**

– Ministry of Finance

UAE will adopt the DCTCE or 5-corner model, utilizing PEPPOL specifications.

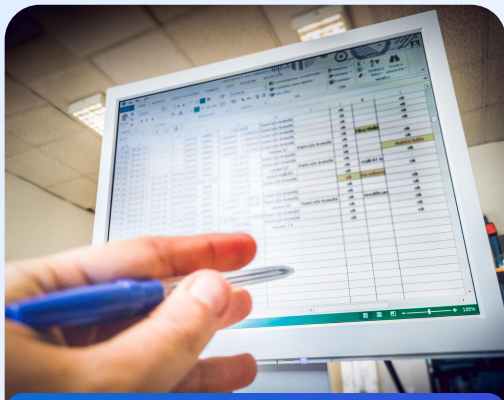
10 years of revolution (VAT) and evolution (e-invoicing) in the UAE

Timeline to implementation



1M+ Taxpayers mandated to go live

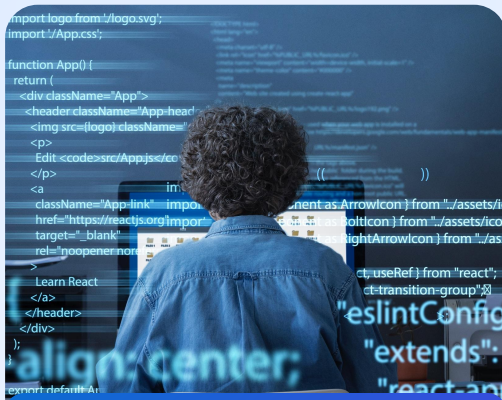
Manual Processes



Unstructured Format

- Human readable
- PDF, Word, Excel
- Periodic Reporting

Digitised Processes



Hybrid Format

- Human and machine readable
- PDF/A-3 with XML
- Real-Time Reporting

Fully Automated Invoice Processing



Structured Format

- Machine readable
- XML(CII/UBL) / JSON
- Continuous Transaction Control



Preparing for e-invoicing

It's the starting point for real-time tax compliance

Challenges

- Intersection of IT and Finance
- Multiple Stakeholders: Internal user teams, customers, vendors, Governments
- IT systems: Different ERP systems, POS systems, Order management systems
- Data: Different data formats, data quality, data correctness, data integrity, data reconciliation
- Different Government mandates: PEPPOL (4 corner and 5 corner), CTC (continuous transaction control) etc

Implementation Risks



Underestimating
Time



Additional/
Unpredictable cost



Lack of
Resources

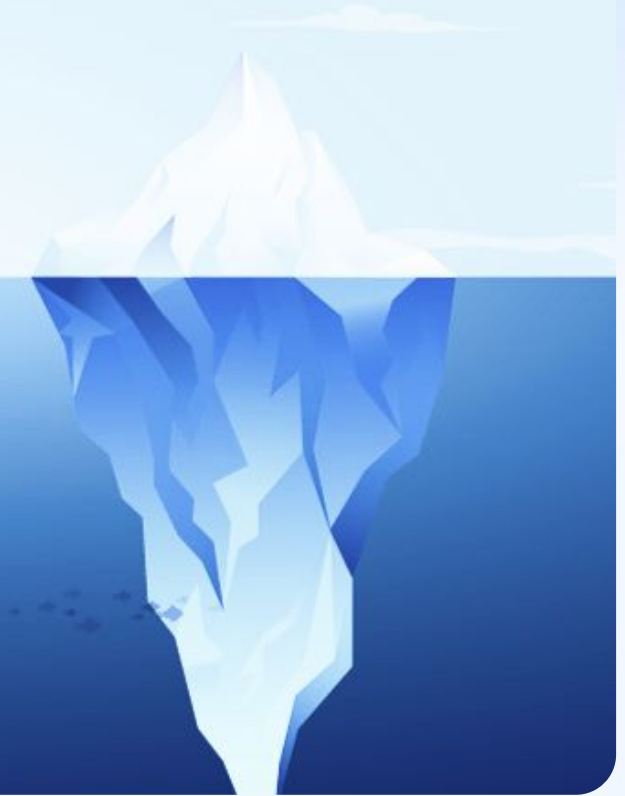


Data
Complexity

Implementing new mandates may initially appear as issues related to manpower, timelines and security

But there are several deeper issues –

Expertise in IT/ Tax/ Compliance, Reconciliation, Hidden costs, etc.



Problems for CFOs to solve

(and collaborate with CIO on)

Disparate ERP systems

Multiple accounting / billing systems – all may not be built with **superior tech architecture**

Evolving tax laws

Digital-first governments continuously launch **new laws/amendments**

Vendor as key stakeholder

Smaller vendors may **not be compliant.**

Reporting 2.0

ERPs **not updating with the new world** of digital tax infra

How should you select technology solutions?



Choose compliant, secure and private

- Local hosting in GCC for data residency
- Secure: ISO27001, SOC-2, GDPR, FTA, SAMA, VAPT, RMIT compliant solutions



Choose single unified platform across geographies

- Just UAE or all MENA support or additionally Asia and EU
- Support for Arabic and local languages



Choose ecosystem expertise (Integrations and Tax)

- Plugins for all major ERPs, POS and OMS Systems
- Ecosystem connect with Big4s, local advisory firms across countries



Choose for future compliance roadmap

- VAT/GST automation and reconciliation solutions for tax assurance
- For future use case coverage: AP automation, AR automation

How will e-Invoicing help you?

(embrace this global change)

More Efficiency

saves time, reduces error,
streamlines processes,

Enhanced Compliance

Automatically generated audit trails, support legal compliance.

Faster Payments, Better Cash Flow

Instant invoice delivery speeds up approval and payments

Better Business Relationships

Smoother transactions, improves customer support

Enhanced Security

Secure transmission and encryption

Expanded Global Reach

Instant cross-border invoicing facilitates international and local business.



e-invoicing isn't the finish line

Use it for re-invention and transformation.

With all finance transactions now digital and certified, you can re-invent:

- Tax Transformation via technology,
- Supply Chain automation,
- Risk detection and prevention,
- AI in finance

What will e-Invoicing change?

Everything

More business impact

Reinforcing the importance of AI



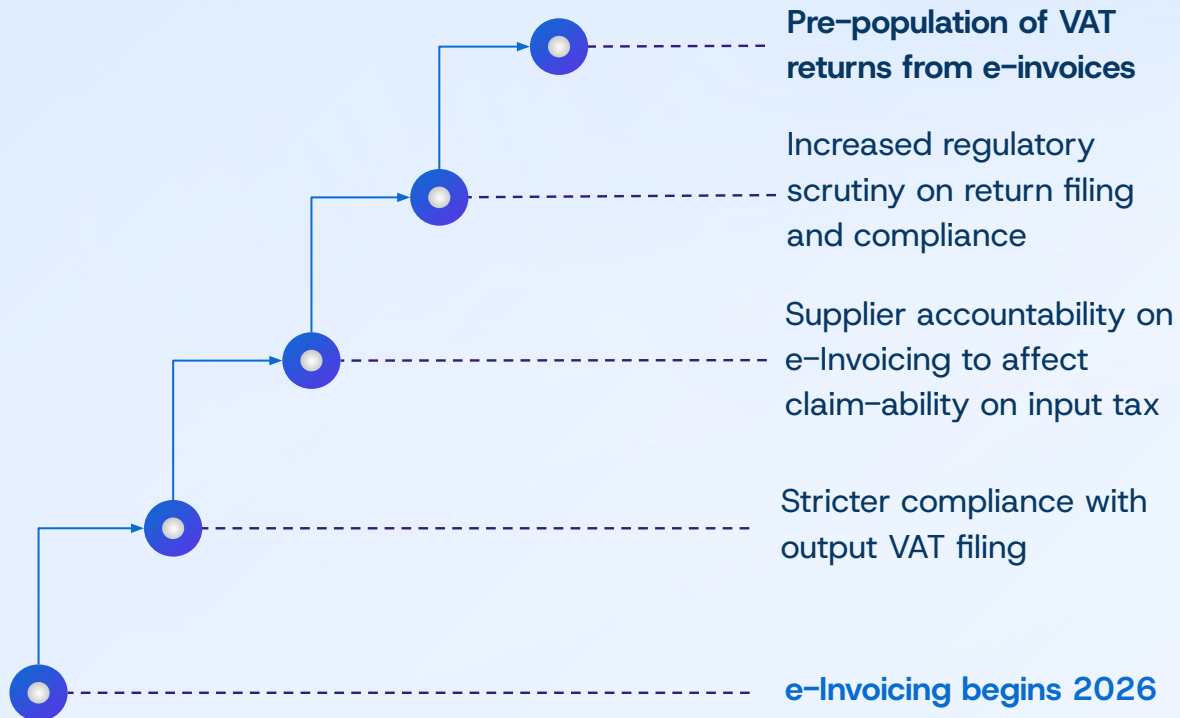
10x more business impact

Reinforcing the importance of AI



Compliance in UAE will evolve beyond e-invoicing

**Faster,
Sharper,
Unforgiving
than ever
before.**



What approach can businesses take?

Legacy Approach

Its a Project by Project approach where there are individual, complex custom projects

Multiple Solutions for each country are needed requiring different vendors & individual integration projects.

Not scalable as it is not easy to react to new mandates

Dependency on service provider professional services

vs



Cleartax Approach

Product based approach which has pre built workflows for each mandate

Single Unified Platform across Geographies

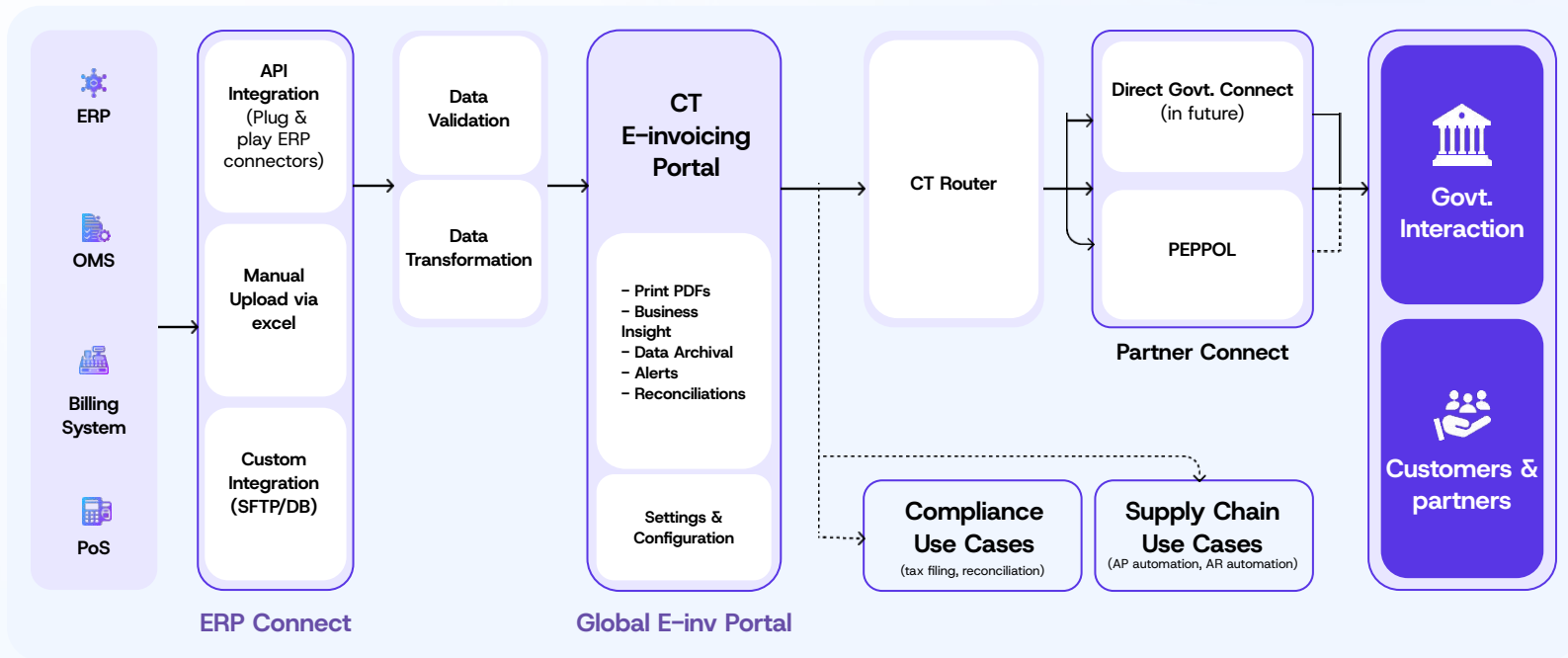
Built for Scale with Security

Deep Partner ecosystem to cover Integrations & Services



Single Global Platform

covering all compliance & automation use-cases for the CFOs office across 50+ countries



**For CFOs, a global platform delivers
true value when powered by AI**

Give AI 2 things, and it will deliver



Data

- Build the most comprehensive finance data lake your team always wanted.
- With AI powered GL-Stream, we are making this unique to you.
- Seamlessly integrate ERP data with GL-Stream and extend it across your network through Peppol for end-to-end compliance intelligence.

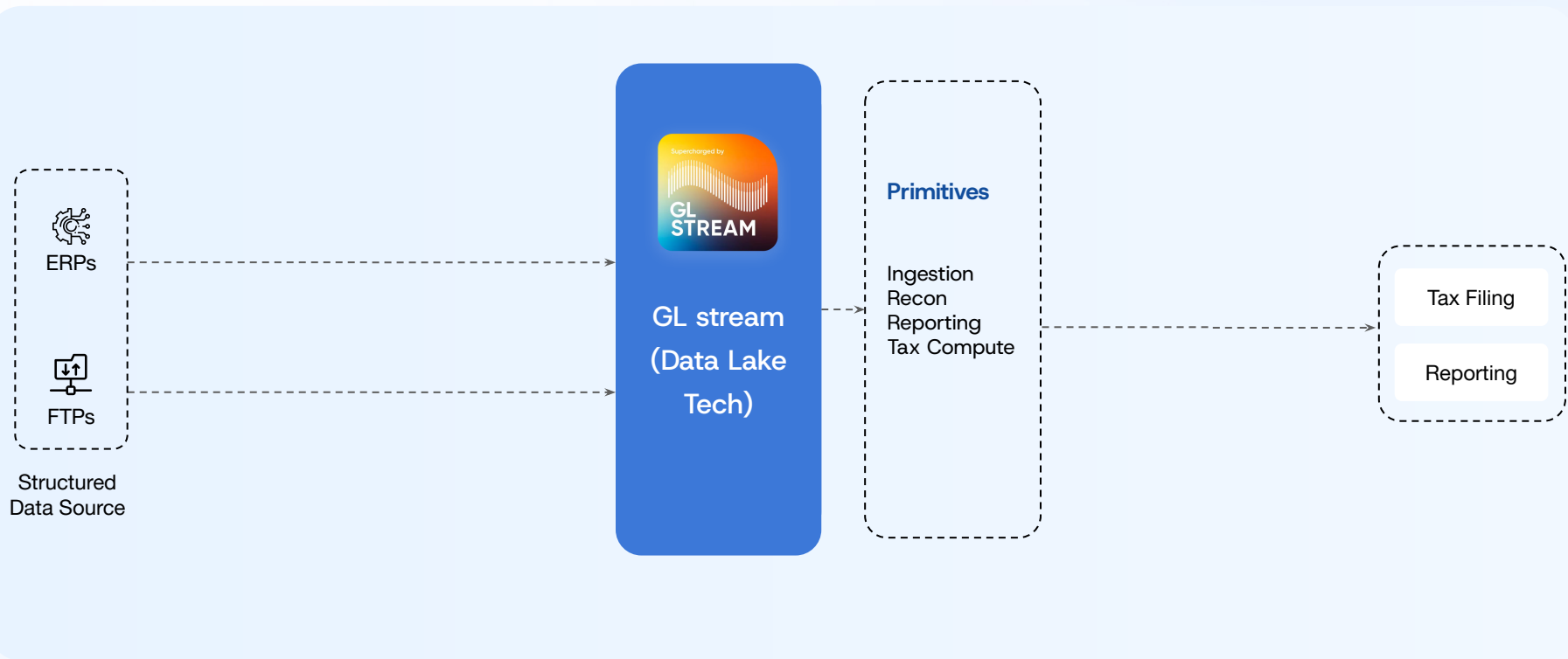


Tools

- Don't use AI for just asking questions/chat.
- Use AI to reconcile, ingest, validate, communicate.
- Put AI to work.

AI + GL Stream Stack

Quick integration, Clean data



What will AI deliver for Finance Teams?



Assurance

All your reporting is **accurate** – so compliance/audit is not a burden.



Data lake

A **single source of truth** to help you with actionable insights – no manual work, no double checking



Adapt to changes

AI Agents will **communicate and coordinate** for you

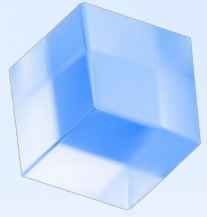
**It is our commitment to help CFOs
design, scale, and deliver value with AI**

The question is not if you adapt,
but how fast you turn
compliance into intelligence?



Key takeaways

- ✓ **Rethink compliance as strategy** – treat e-invoicing as a catalyst for finance transformation, not just a mandate.
- ✓ **Put data at the center** – every invoice is structured intelligence; unlock insights, not just reports.
- ✓ **Prepare for CTC and beyond** – UAE is only the start; global convergence on pre-issuance models is inevitable.
- ✓ **Build trust through transparency** – validated, standardized data strengthens credibility with regulators and stakeholders.
- ✓ **Experiment with AI now** – start with pilots in reconciliation, anomaly detection, or forecasting; scale as data quality improves.



Thank you!

